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Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479
Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-8762
Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

Submitter Information

Name: Dan Jones
Email: [REDACTED]

General Comment

My comment is attached; thank you.

Attachments

PublicCommentOnAI

Dan Jones

3D Artist

Re: National Science Foundation's Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

As an artist who has worked for the past 18 years in television, film, and video games, and as an avid fan of technology in general, I have watched the rise of Generative AI with great interest.

While there is clearly potential for these systems to do interesting things (though I would argue they have, as of yet, failed to materialize as anything close to what has been promised) they have always been a non-starter for me, simply because all of the heavy hitters' models are based on tremendous amounts of theft.

The United States is the center of the entertainment universe, and that is made possible, in part, by our copyright system and our protections of intellectual property. **It has never been appropriate to use another artist or author's work for profit without first seeking the legal rights to do so, which would typically include credit and compensation.** Any rookie artist in the entertainment industry can tell you that they would lose their job in an instant if they took another artist's imagery or an author's words and tried to use it in a film or a television commercial. And yet we have wealthy CEOs (who should and do know better) arguing that *they* should be allowed to use *millions* of artists' images and authors' written word for their own profit.

Their defense? "Because we did it already. And our business model wouldn't work if we had to compensate people for the content we stole."

Well, if your business doesn't work without theft, you don't have a business; you have a racket.

That's really all there is to it. If you can't run a GenAI business without theft, you shouldn't be allowed to run it.

It really doesn't matter that dozens of tech-lords have already sunk billions of dollars into a failed venture. As the saying goes, "Play stupid games; win stupid prizes."

As embarrassing as it might be for some of our biggest tech companies to have egg on their face by being forced to start their models over ethically, using data they've properly secured the rights to use, that is far better than the alternative where we sacrifice our long-lived and robust copyright system in service to an as-yet unproven (not to mention incredibly energy-hungry) technology that may or may not ever fulfill any of the lofty promises.

I urge all parties to exercise caution and retain the very necessary copyright guardrails to protect the thriving American entertainment industry, and not to be swayed by a handful of rich guys trying to dazzle you with glittering fantasies of future benefits that may never arrive.

Thank you,

Dan Jones